

Unreal Horde Agent Deployment (Windows)



Hidde Derks
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Initially created for the Breda University of Applied Sciences Master's of Game Technologies

To start benefiting from the Unreal Build Accelerator you need to have a server set up for agents to connect to. In case you're looking for server set up, choose one of the following:

Horde Server (Windows)

Horde Server (Docker)

This guide will focus on deploying the Horde Agent in Windows, if you're looking for the Docker deployment, go here:

Horde Agent (Docker/Linux)

Before getting started with this guide, you do need to have an existing Horde Server up and running, with both a URL for accessing that server, along with a user account that is permitted to `AddComputeTasks` in the `globals.json > plugins > compute > clusters > ac1` entries, or an Admin account (if authentication is enabled on said server).

Step 1.

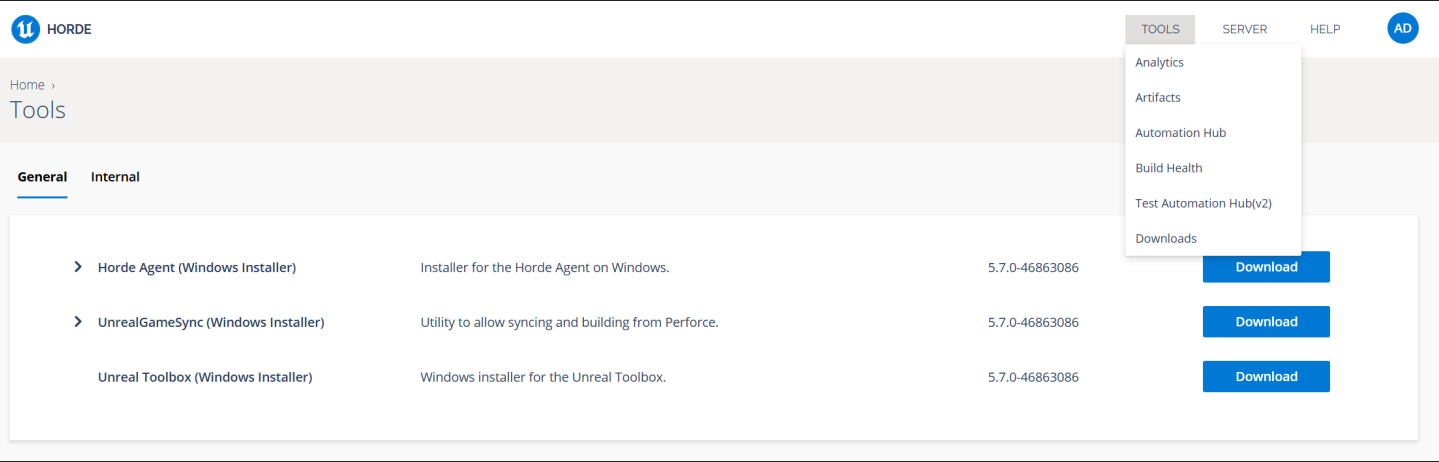
Using a web browser, navigate to the Horde Server URL that you got from your teammate that set up the Horde Server. This will be in one of the following formats:

`https://horde.sigma-erebus.com/`

`http://192.168.0.204:13340/`

This Horde URL will also be referenced in later parts in the setup, and should be used there to connect to the server correctly

This might require a login to the server, but once you're in the dashboard, you can go to the `Tools > Downloads`.

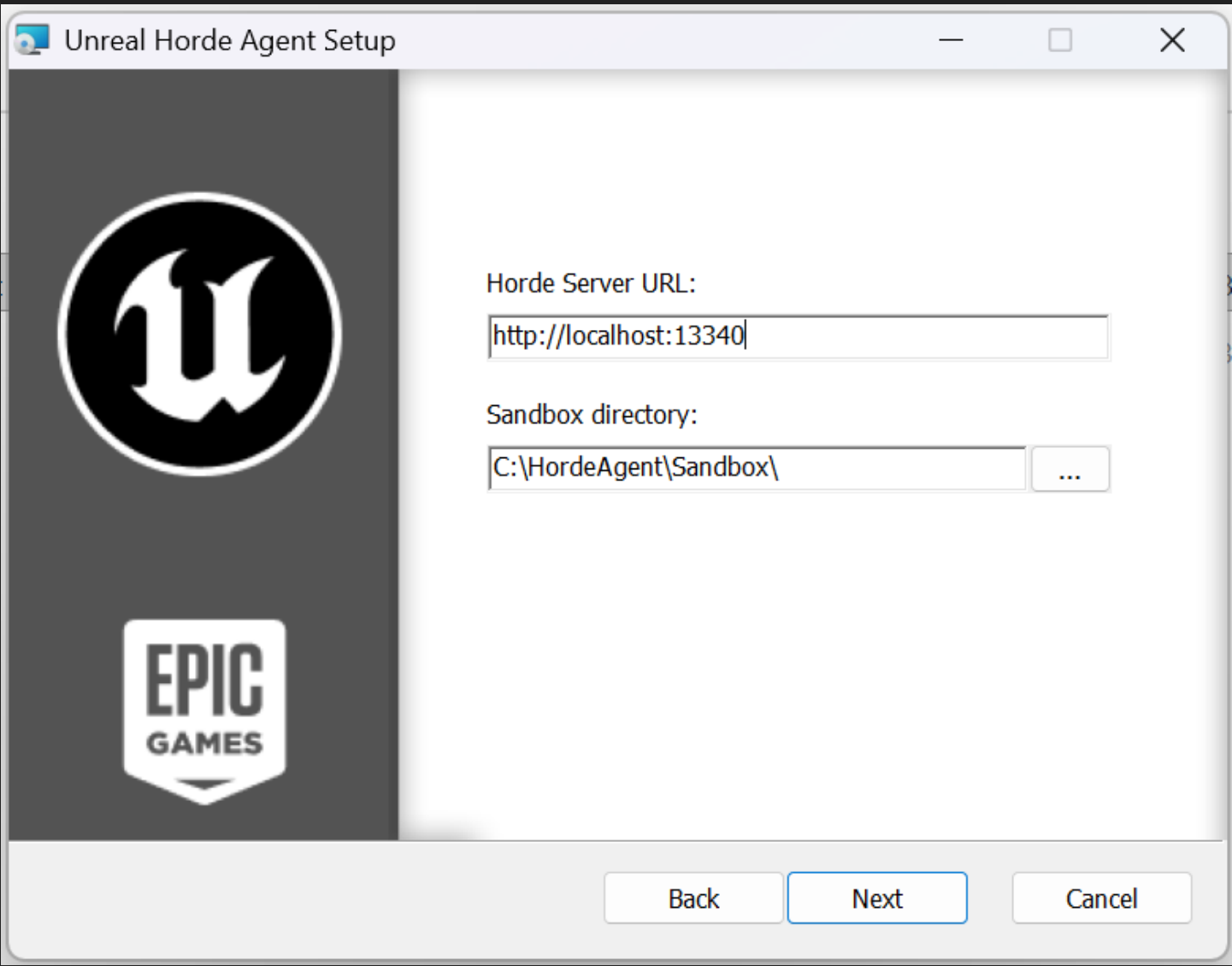


Here we'll need to download the 'Horde Agent (Windows Installer)'.

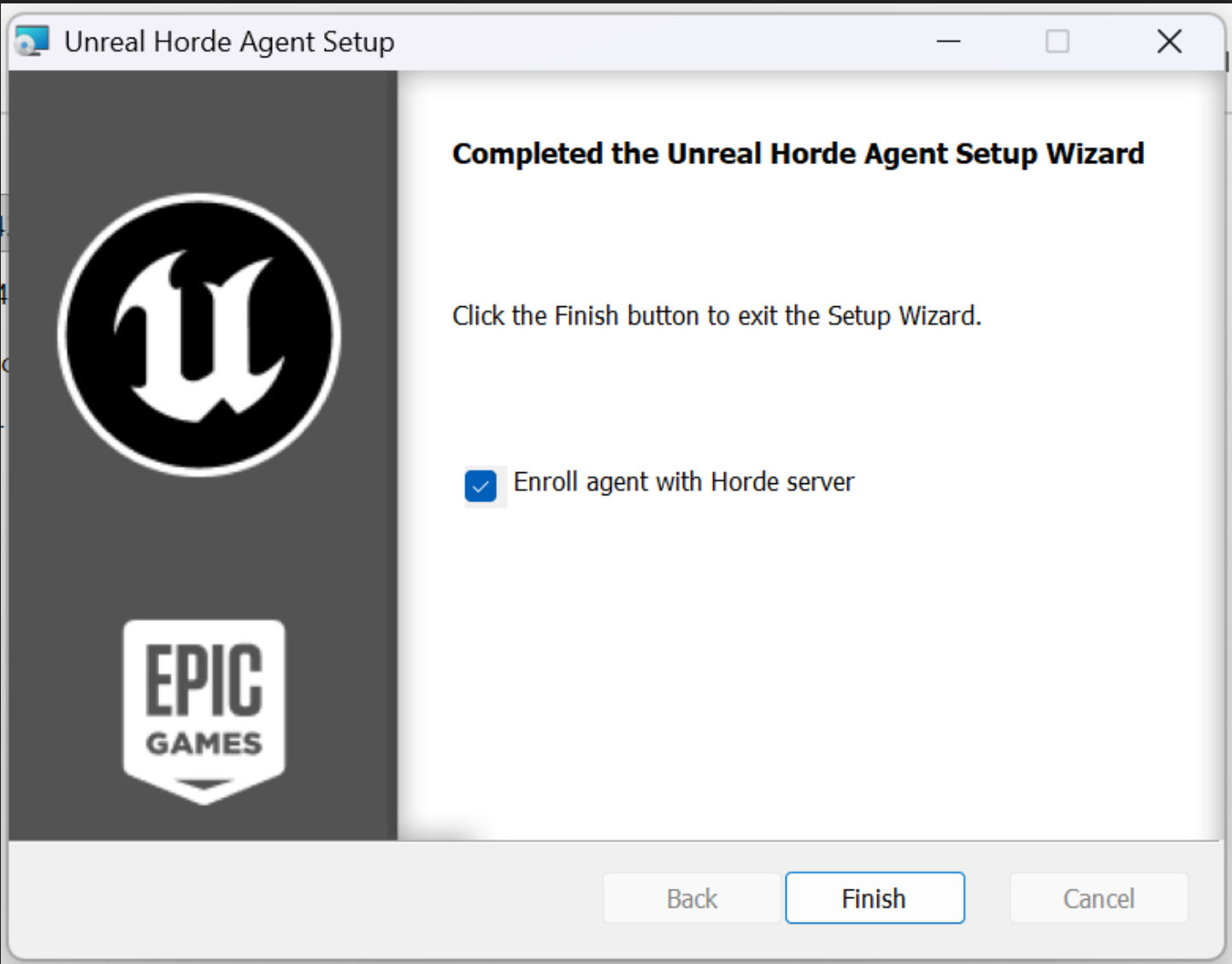
Step 2.

Run this installer, and make sure that in the `Horde Server URL`, you enter the appropriate URL to point to your Horde Server instance. (if desired, on this page you can also tweak the Sandbox directory, which is where temporary files will be stored during builds):

Horde Server URL in the setup should match the URL from step 1

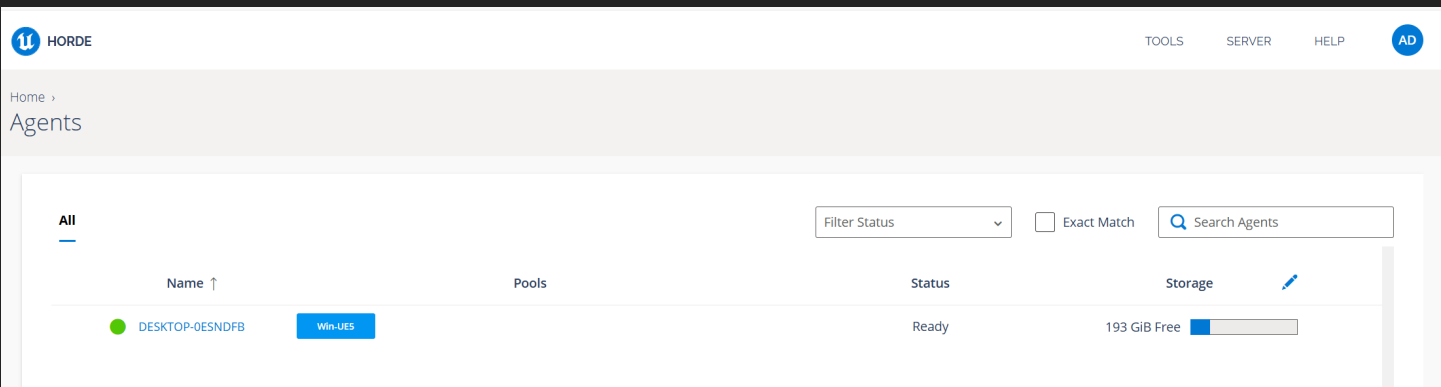
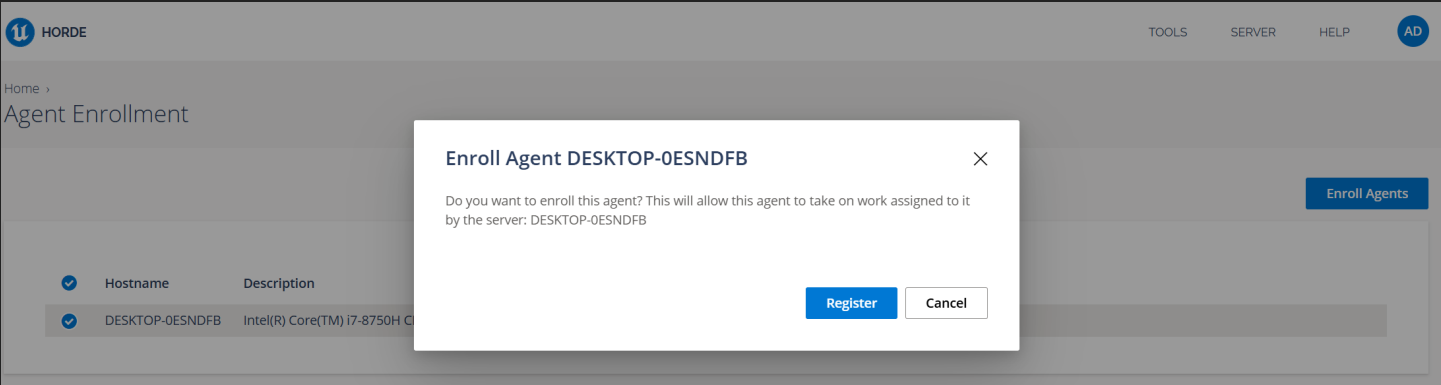


And at the end of the installation, keep the "Enroll agent with Horde server" checked.



Step 3.

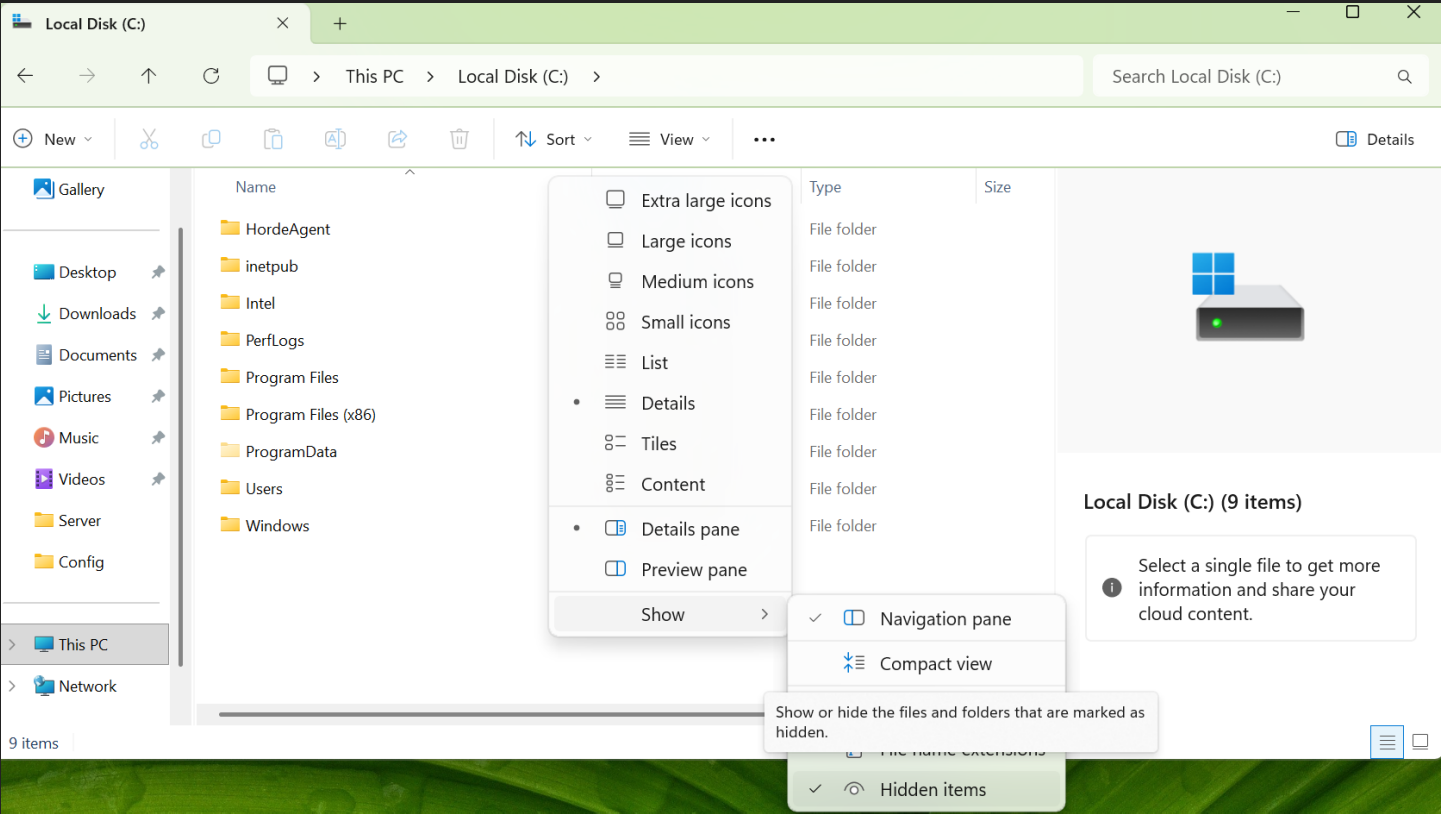
Now that the agent has requested to enroll with the server, it will still need to be accepted. To do so, go to the `Server > Agent Enrollment` in the Horde dashboard. This will prompt you, asking whether you want to enroll this agent. Register/Enroll the agent, and it will show up in the `Server > Agents` list.



Should you not see these Unreal Horde screens, and instead get an error, uninstall the Horde Agent from `Windows Settings > Apps > Installed apps > Find "Unreal Horde Agent" > clicking the 3 dots and and selecting "Uninstall" in the drop down menu` , after which, repeat **Step 2** and ensure that you set the Horde Server URL correctly in the installation.

Step 4.

For this step, we need to enable hidden files in file explorer, as `ProgramData` by default is a hidden folder in windows:



For a lot of cases, this would be enough for agents to connect together. But in some cases (especially with a VPN), there will be some additional setup that you might want to do. This setup will be done in the `agent.json` file, found in `C:/ProgramData/Epic/Horde/Agent` . This file can be used to configure some specifics about the agent and how it presents its capabilities to the Horde Server. The structure of the file should be as following:

Copy and tweak the file according to your requirements, such as giving your agent a name, computeIP, and a Team Name

```
{
  "horde": {
    // ephemeral agents are forgotten as soon as disconnected
    "ephemeral": false,
    // if unused will default to the computer's name, but can be used to
    "name": "Laptop-Hidde",
    // the IP on which other agents can reach this agent. Should be the
    "computeIp": "192.168.0.204",
    // additional properties to add to the agent that pool allocations of
    "properties" {
      "TeamName": "Team-A"
    }
  }
}
```

agent.json

Step 5.

At this point in the setup, we are ready to start accepting compile jobs from the cluster. But we are not quite set up to send our compile jobs to other agents on the cluster. This is configured in the `Engine.ini` config files. for projects this is done by adding the following elements to the `ProjectFolder/Config/DefaultEngine.ini` or `EngineFolder/Engine/Config/BaseEngine.ini` , making sure to tweak the server URLs to your own Horde server:

Copy the snippets and paste them at the end of the Engine.ini file, adjusting the URL to point to the correct Horde Server

```
[UbaController]
+Providers=Uba.Provider.Horde.YourServer
[Uba.Provider.Horde.YourServer]
ServerUrl="https://horde.example.com/"
Pool=Win-UE5
Enabled=True
Encryption="Aes"
```

Unreal Build Accelerator additions to the *Engine.ini file

The next section is for telemetry integration, which can be left out entirely. But if wanted, the `APIServerET` needs to be set to your Horde server URL as well, and the `APIEndpointET` is set to `api/v1/telemetry/<AnalyticsStoreID>` , where the `AnalyticsStoreID` is configured in the `globals.json` file on the server ("engine" if following the server installation tutorial as well).

```
[StudioTelemetry.Provider.Horde]
Name=HordeAnalytics
ProviderModule=AnalyticsET
UsageType=EditorAndClient
APIKeyET=HordeAnalytics.Dev
APIServerET="https://horde.example.com/"
APIEndpointET="api/v1/telemetry/engine"
```

Telemetry additions to the *Engine.ini file

Step 6.

Done!

Now that the agent is installed and configured, you can continue to use Unreal Engine as usual, with the benefits from the Unreal Build Accelerator

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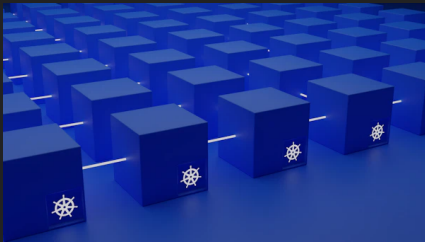
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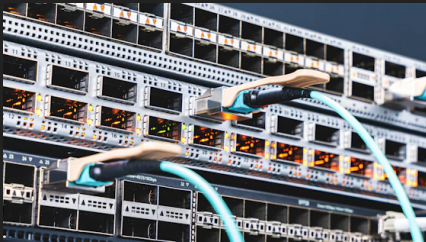
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